

D744

Student Teaching I in Elementary and Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

In a second-grade class decorated for the fall festival, a candidate pours the same amount of water into a short wide cup and a tall thin cup. Most children say the tall cup has more. The class has a new student from Ohio. What does this show, and what is the best next step?

- A. Check whether the new student understands.
- B. They are still learning conservation; let them pour water back and forth and measure it to see the amount stays the same.
- C. Explain the abstract rule that volume is invariant and move on.
- D. They cannot reason logically, so avoid measurement until later grades.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A fourth-grade candidate wants students to reason about fractions. Which task best fits concrete operational thinkers?

- A. Watch a video about fractions without materials.
- B. Prove a general rule for comparing any fractions.
- C. Compare $\frac{2}{3}$ and $\frac{3}{4}$ using fraction strips before writing an explanation.
- D. Memorize a list of equivalent fractions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A candidate teaches a 25-minute mini-lesson on paragraph structure to third graders. The room has a new reading rug, and the lesson follows music class. By minute 12, many students are fidgeting. What is the best change?

- A. Move the lesson so it no longer follows music.
- B. Speak more loudly to hold attention.
- C. Split it into short teaching chunks with a quick turn-and-talk or practice task between each.
- D. Keep the 25 minutes and give a movement break at the end.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher plans 32 minutes of direct instruction for second graders in equal chunks of 8 minutes each. How many active processing breaks should fall between chunks?

- A.** 4
- B.** 0, since breaks waste instruction time.
- C.** 3
- D.** 8

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A first grader with autism will have a substitute teacher on Friday for the first time this year. He enjoys trains and eats lunch at 11:15. What should the candidate do?

- A.** Give him a train toy to hold all day Friday.
- B.** Read a short personalized story about having a substitute on the days before Friday.
- C.** Keep him home on Friday.
- D.** Read the story after he becomes upset on Friday.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A kindergartner with a developmental delay refuses to start handwriting practice but loves the sand table. The class pet is a turtle named Pickles. The candidate uses a first-then board. Which setup is correct?

- A.** First: handwriting (short set). Then: sand table, given right after the writing is done.
- B.** First: handwriting. Then: sand table, but only if the whole class behaves.
- C.** First: handwriting. Then: feed Pickles.
- D.** First: sand table. Then: handwriting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A first-then board has stopped working. The student finishes the 'first' task, but the teacher often says, "We ran out of time for the 'then.'" What is the most likely cause?

- A.** The student needs the 'then' activity before the task.
- B.** The promise is broken, so the 'then' no longer predicts reward and the board loses its power.
- C.** First-then boards never work after a few weeks.
- D.** The 'first' task is too easy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

After a lesson, the cooperating teacher, who has won a district teaching award, says, “Your transitions took about six minutes each.” The candidate stayed up late making materials. What is the best first response?

- A. “Which transition was the slowest, and what did you see students doing?”
- B. “OK.”
- C. “The materials took longer to pass out because I made them last night.”
- D. “That’s just how the students are after lunch.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A candidate wants third graders to practice explaining their math thinking aloud. The school just bought tablets, and a colleague raves about a new game app with leaderboards. Which choice best fits the goal?

- A. A simple screen-recording tool where students solve a problem and record their spoken explanation.
- B. The game app with leaderboards.
- C. Any app, since tablets always boost learning.
- D. An e-book reader app.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher has chosen a digital drawing app. Which learning goal does it fit best?

- A. Students memorize spelling words by typing.
- B. Any goal, since the app is engaging.
- C. Students build reading fluency.
- D. Students create labeled diagrams of the plant life cycle.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A candidate plans a science inquiry for fifth graders. For a table of English learners who recently arrived, she writes, “They will just color the diagram.” The school is near a river, and the unit is on water quality. What is the best revision?

- A.** Excuse them from science until they are fluent.
- B.** Keep the coloring task because language is a barrier.
- C.** Have them take a field trip to the river instead.
- D.** Keep the same inquiry goal and add supports such as visuals, sentence frames, and partner talk.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A second grader receives speech therapy twice a week for articulation of the /r/ sound. The speech therapist shares an office with the counselor and drives a red van. How can the candidate best collaborate?

- A.** Correct every /r/ error during every lesson.
- B.** Talk to the counselor, since she shares the office.
- C.** Leave articulation to the therapist, since that is her job.
- D.** Ask the therapist for one cue to use in class and share notes on how the student is doing during reading.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

In a second-grade class ~~decorated for the fall festival~~, a candidate pours the same amount of water into a short wide cup and a tall thin cup. Most children say the tall cup has more. ~~The class has a new student from Ohio.~~ What does this show, and what is the best next step?

Target word: developmental reading and next step **Decides:** Children are not yet conserving; they are moving into concrete operations.

A	Camouflage	Uses the new-student detail; most of the class shows the pattern.
B	Correct	Concrete, hands-on checks support the move into concrete operational reasoning.
C	Adjacent category	Abstract explanation does not fit concrete-stage learners.
D	Absolute language	Children this age are building logical reasoning with concrete supports.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A fourth-grade candidate wants students to reason about fractions. Which task best fits concrete operational thinkers?

Target word: reverse: design for the stage **Decides:** Logical reasoning with visible, handled objects.

A	Dropped element	Drops the hands-on element.
B	Inverted operation	Abstract proof fits formal operations.
C	Correct	Concrete materials support logical comparison.
D	Confusion set	Rote memory, not reasoning.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A candidate teaches a 25-minute mini-lesson on paragraph structure to third graders. ~~The room has a new reading rug, and the lesson follows music class.~~ By minute 12, many students are fidgeting. What is the best change?

Target word: structure of instruction **Decides:** Teacher talk runs longer than attention for age.

A	Camouflage	Uses the schedule detail; the length is the issue.
B	Confusion set	Volume does not change attention span.
C	Correct	Short chunks with active processing match young learners' attention.
D	Dropped element	Drops the chunking; attention is already gone by the end.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

A teacher plans 32 minutes of direct instruction for second graders in equal chunks of 8 minutes each. How many active processing breaks should fall between chunks?

Target word: solve for number of breaks **Decides:** Breaks fall between chunks: chunks – 1.

A	Inverted operation	Counts one break per chunk instead of between chunks.
B	Absolute language	Processing breaks are part of learning.
C	Correct	$32 / 8 = 4$ chunks, so there are 3 breaks between them.
D	Wrong stem number	Uses the chunk length as the count.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A first grader with autism will have a substitute teacher on Friday for the first time this year. ~~He enjoys trains and eats lunch at 11:15.~~ What should the candidate do?

Target word: prepare for change **Decides:** A new situation is coming.

A	Camouflage	Uses the interest detail; comfort item does not prepare him for what to expect.
B	Correct	A social narrative before the situation prepares him for the change.
C	Absolute language	Avoidance removes learning and is not the teacher's call.
D	Inverted operation	The narrative is a preparation tool, not a response.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A kindergartner with a developmental delay refuses to start handwriting practice but loves the sand table. ~~The class pet is a turtle named Pickles.~~ The candidate uses a first-then board. Which setup is correct?

Target word: order on the board **Decides:** Less-preferred first, preferred then.

A	Correct	The preferred activity follows and reinforces the task.
B	Adjacent category	Adds a group condition, breaking the promise tied to his task.
C	Camouflage	Uses the pet detail; the known preference is the sand table.
D	Inverted operation	Gives the reward before the task.

7. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A first-then board has stopped working. The student finishes the 'first' task, but the teacher often says, "We ran out of time for the 'then.'" What is the most likely cause?

Target word: reverse: diagnose a failing board **Decides:** The promised preferred activity is not delivered.

A	Inverted operation	Reverses the order the tool depends on.
B	Correct	First-then works only if the 'then' reliably follows.
C	Absolute language	They keep working when the promise is kept.
D	Confusion set	The student finishes it; task difficulty is not the problem.

8. Answer A Concept 5

After a lesson, the cooperating teacher, ~~who has won a district teaching award,~~ says, "Your transitions took about six minutes each." ~~The candidate stayed up late making materials.~~ What is the best first response?

Target word: first response to feedback **Decides:** Seek understanding first.

A	Correct	Clarifies the evidence before responding.
B	Dropped element	Drops the inquiry that makes the feedback usable.
C	Camouflage	Uses the late-night detail to explain, not to understand.
D	Inverted operation	Defends instead of seeking to understand.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A candidate wants third graders to practice explaining their math thinking aloud. The school just bought tablets, and ~~a colleague raves about a new game app with leaderboards.~~ Which choice best fits the goal?

Target word: tool selection **Decides:** Goal is explaining thinking aloud.

A	Correct	The tool directly supports the goal of explaining thinking.
B	Camouflage	Popular and fun, but it rewards speed, not explanation.
C	Absolute language	Devices do not help unless matched to the goal.
D	Adjacent category	Supports reading, not explaining math.

10. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

A teacher has chosen a digital drawing app. Which learning goal does it fit best?

Target word: reverse: from tool to goal **Decides:** Tool features match the student action.

A	Adjacent category	Typing practice fits a different tool.
B	Inverted operation	Starts from the tool instead of the goal.
C	Confusion set	A drawing app does not support oral reading.
D	Correct	Drawing and labeling are what the tool does.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A candidate plans a science inquiry for fifth graders. For a table of English learners who recently arrived, she writes, "They will just color the diagram." ~~The school is near a river, and the unit is on water quality.~~ What is the best revision?

Target word: fix a deficit-based plan **Decides:** Goal was lowered based on a group label.

A	Absolute language	Removes access; content and language grow together.
B	Inverted operation	Keeps the lowered goal.
C	Camouflage	Uses the river detail; it does not address expectations.
D	Correct	Maintains rigor and adds support.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A second grader receives speech therapy twice a week for articulation of the /r/ sound. ~~The speech therapist shares an office with the counselor and drives a red van.~~ How can the candidate best collaborate?

Target word: classroom carryover **Decides:** Therapy goals need practice in class.

A	Absolute language	Constant correction can harm confidence; use the agreed cue.
B	Camouflage	Uses the office detail; the counselor is not the provider.
C	Adjacent category	Treats therapy as separate; skills need classroom practice.
D	Correct	Two-way sharing carries therapy strategies into the classroom.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Concrete operational thinking	Most children about 7-11 reason logically about concrete, visible things (they conserve quantity) but struggle with purely abstract or hypothetical ideas.	Expecting elementary students to reason abstractly without objects or examples, or thinking they cannot reason logically at all.	A task asks children to reason about something they can or cannot see.
2	Chunking to fit attention	Break direct instruction into short segments matched to age, with active processing between chunks.	Delivering a long lecture and adding a break only at the end.	Attention drops partway through a long teacher-talk segment.
3	Social narratives	A short, individualized story that describes a situation, what people do, and what to expect helps a student prepare for new or hard routines; read it before the situation.	Reading the story only after the student has struggled, as a consequence.	A student with autism faces a new or changed routine.
4	First-then boards	A first-then visual pairs a less-preferred task (first) with a preferred activity (then), and the promise is always kept after the first task.	Putting the preferred item first or giving it before the task is done.	A student resists starting a task but has a known preference.
5	Clarify before responding to feedback	When receiving feedback, ask questions to understand the evidence and the suggestion before explaining or defending.	Immediately explaining why the lesson went that way.	A mentor gives critical feedback in a debrief.
6	Tool chosen by learning goal	Pick classroom technology by what it lets students do toward the objective, not by novelty or features.	Choosing the newest or most popular app first and fitting the lesson around it.	A teacher choosing between several apps for a lesson.
7	High expectations vs. deficit thinking	Keep the same rigorous goal for all students and add support; do not lower goals based on background.	Assigning easier work to students because of their home language, income, or neighborhood.	A plan changes expectations based on a group label.
8	Collaborating with related-service providers	Coordinate with speech, occupational, and physical therapists so strategies from therapy are used in class, and share classroom data back.	Treating therapy as a separate pull-out world with no classroom carryover.	A student receives speech, OT, or PT services.

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching I is the first part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. This course provides a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate and reflect upon professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies rooted in students' learning and developmental patterns. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed in Advanced Clinical, candidates will receive ongoing feedback through observations and evaluations. Feedback will encourage candidates to reflect on their commitment to professional practices as educators, analyze and adjust teaching methods, and explore new teaching materials and methods that are culturally relevant. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve into communication and collaboration, accepting feedback, creating positive learning environments, and technology and online learning. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.